

TB AudioPlayer

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Overview

Loads a user sample and plays it as a one-shot from PLAY or a host Trigger, with click-free retrigger and stop fades.

What this plug-in solves

Triggering one sound should not require a full sampler or custom playback code. TB AudioPlayer loads a user-selected sample, starts it from PLAY or an external host Trigger, and handles rapid retriggering without an abrupt cut. It is designed for effects, voice clips, drum hits, and other short one-shots in a DAW, Standalone app, or compatible VST3 host.

What you can expect

- Direct loading of WAV, AIFF, FLAC, or Ogg files with clear sample information and status
- Immediate one-shot playback from PLAY or an automatable 0-to-1 Trigger edge
- Click-free retrigger and STOP behavior using a fixed 50 ms fade for outgoing playback
- Session and User preset recall of the selected file path, with Undo and Redo for sample choices

How it works

BROWSE decodes the selected file into memory outside the audio callback. Playback reads that prepared data and converts the source rate to the host rate, so browsing and decoding do not run on the real-time audio thread.

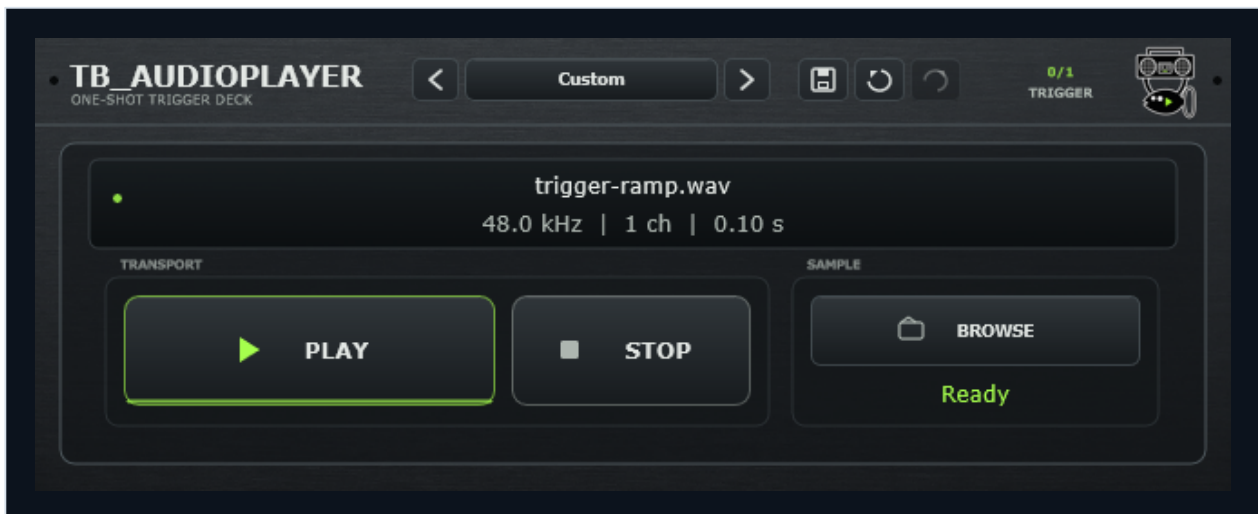
Trigger reacts only to a 0-to-1 edge at a processing-block boundary. A new shot begins from the start while earlier playback fades for 50 ms, and STOP applies the same fixed fade to all active voices.

The plug-in stores the selected file path rather than the audio itself. Presets and sessions can restore the choice only while that external file remains available.

Quick start

- 1** Open TB AudioPlayer as a VST3 instrument or Standalone app and click BROWSE.
- 2** Choose a short WAV, AIFF, FLAC, or Ogg file and confirm that its name, sample rate, channel count, duration, and Ready status appear.
- 3** Click PLAY and confirm that the sample begins from the start at its natural speed.
- 4** Click PLAY again during playback to hear the new shot begin while the previous one fades for 50 ms.
- 5** For host control, automate Trigger from 0 to 1 and return it to 0 before the next event.
- 6** Use STOP when all active shots should fade to silence, rather than using it as a pause control.
- 7** Save a .tbap User preset or the DAW session, then keep the referenced sample available at the same path for reliable recall.

Interface and key sections



This is a direct capture of the current plug-in interface. Use the visible labels to locate the areas and controls explained below.

Sample browser and file display

BROWSE opens an asynchronous file chooser for WAV, AIFF, FLAC, or Ogg audio. After a successful load, the display shows the file name, source sample rate, channel count, and duration, while the status line reports Ready. A rejected or unreadable file reports an error without replacing the current playable sample.

PLAY and automatable Trigger

PLAY starts the selected sample from its beginning through the same trigger path exposed to the host. The automatable Trigger reacts only to a 0-to-1 rising edge; holding it at 1 does not repeat playback, so it must return to 0 before another external trigger. Host events are consumed at the processing-block boundary.

Retrigger and STOP fades

When a new trigger arrives during playback, the new shot starts immediately from the beginning while the previous shot fades from its current level to silence over 50 ms. STOP applies the same 50 ms linear fade to every active voice. These fades prevent abrupt cuts; they are not an editable amplitude envelope.

Playback rate and channel handling

The plug-in plays mono or stereo source files to a matching mono or stereo output and performs four-point cubic sample-rate conversion when the source and host rates differ. It has no audio input and does not change pitch or duration as a creative effect.

Preset, history, and session recall

The header provides Previous, the current preset menu, Next, Save User Preset, Undo, and Redo. The Factory set contains START > Init, which clears the sample and returns Trigger to 0. User presets use the .tbap extension and are kept in Documents/TB_AudioPlayer/Presets/User. Presets and DAW sessions store the selected file path rather than embedding the audio, and the transient Trigger state always returns as 0.

Supported paths and limits

Samples are decoded into memory outside the audio callback, with a maximum decoded size of 256 MiB. The current Windows x64 release provides VST3 and Standalone forms. It does not provide MP3 decoding, MIDI triggering, looping, pitch shifting, time stretching, gain or envelope editing, disk streaming, or audio-file embedding.

Controllable properties

The guide uses the names shown on the plug-in panel. Each explanation describes the audible result, a useful way to approach the control, and an important interaction to listen for.

Control	What it does and when to use it
PLAY / TRIGGER	Starts the selected sample on a 0-to-1 edge. PLAY generates the same trigger action from the panel. Return host automation to 0 after each event so the next rising edge can fire.
STOP	Fades every active voice to silence over 50 ms. Use STOP to end playback smoothly; press PLAY again if a fresh shot should begin instead.
BROWSE	Opens the file chooser for a supported WAV, AIFF, FLAC, or Ogg sample. Keep short production samples in a stable folder so presets and sessions can find them again.
PREVIOUS / PRESET / NEXT	Moves through Init and User presets and shows the current selection or Custom state. Use Init for a safe empty state and verify every recalled User preset can still reach its source file.
SAVE USER PRESET	Saves the selected sample path and stable state as a .tbap User preset. Name the preset for the sound and keep the referenced audio beside a managed library or project.
UNDO / REDO	Moves backward or forward through sample-selection changes. Use these for recent file choices; they do not undo host Trigger automation or transport events.
HOST BYPASS	Exposes the host's generic plug-in bypass parameter; it is not a transport control. Use STOP when active voices must fade out; host bypass behavior is controlled by the host.

Practical uses

DAW one-shot automation

- Load a short effect, voice clip, or drum hit with BROWSE.
- Create a Trigger automation lane that returns to 0 between events.
- Place each 0-to-1 edge where the one-shot should begin and leave enough time for the file to play or be retriggered.
- Render or record a test pass and adjust event placement if the host uses large processing blocks.

Expected result: The same selected sample starts repeatably from host automation without MIDI mapping or a full sampler setup.

Rapid retrigger layering

- Choose a transient sample and start it with PLAY.
- Retrigger before the first shot finishes to create overlapping attacks.
- Listen to the outgoing 50 ms fade and leave enough space when a denser overlap would mask the new attack.
- Use STOP to end the complete stack with the same click-free fade.

Expected result: New attacks remain immediate while older playback leaves smoothly instead of being cut off abruptly.

Standalone sample audition

- Open the Standalone application and browse to a folder of short source files.
- Load one file at a time and compare the displayed rate, channels, and duration before pressing PLAY.
- Use Undo and Redo to move between recent sample selections.
- Save useful selections as User presets only when the source files will remain in stable locations.

Expected result: A compact trigger deck can audition and recall one-shots without opening a DAW project.

Portable session preparation

- Place the chosen sample in a stable project or library folder before saving the preset or DAW session.
- Recall the state and verify that the file loads and the display returns to Ready.
- When moving the project to another computer, copy the source sample separately and reselect it if the path changes.
- Use Init when the session should open in a safe state with no selected sample.

Expected result: The session remains predictable because the manual treats the stored path and the audio file as separate assets.

Common pitfalls

If PLAY or Trigger produces no sound, load a supported sample first and confirm that the status line says Ready.

A Trigger value held at 1 fires only once; return it to 0 before the next 0-to-1 edge.

Trigger timing follows host processing blocks, so it is not a sample-accurate MIDI note input.

Presets and sessions store a file path, not the sample data. A missing or moved file must be located again.

Unsupported, unreadable, or over-limit files are rejected without replacing the currently playable sample.

The 50 ms retrigger and STOP fades are fixed safety behavior, not editable envelopes or crossfade controls.

Long program material is not the intended use because files are decoded into memory and limited to 256 MiB.

The plug-in does not provide MP3, MIDI, loop, pitch, gain, envelope, time-stretch, streaming, or audio-input features.